Creating a New React Project

Let's dive right in and kickstart our journey into the world of React. In this lesson, we'll be working on a practical exercise to build a basic React project. Here's what we'll do:

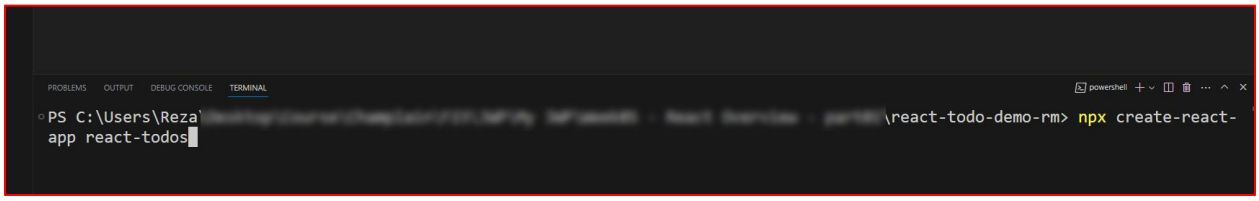
Step 1: Setting Up the Project

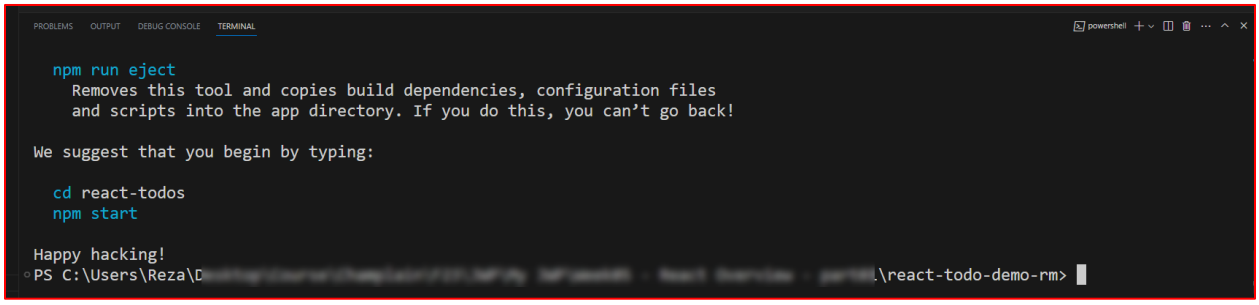
1. **Open Your File Structure**: Navigate to where you want to create the project folder.
2. **Create a New Folder**: Name this folder `react-todo-demo`. This will hold our project files.
3. **Open Visual Studio Code (VS Code)**: Head to `File` > `Open Folder`, navigate to your newly created folder, and click `Open`.
4. **Trust the Authors**: If prompted, confirm that you trust the authors of the files in this folder.

Step 2: Initiating the React Project

1. **Open a New Terminal**: Go to the terminal in VS Code and create a new instance.
2. **Create a New React Project**: Type the following command to initiate the React project:

```
npx create-react-app react-todos
```





Note: This installation may take a while, depending on your internet speed.

Step 3: Understanding the Initial Information

Upon successful installation, React provides some starting information:

- `npm start`: Starts the development server.
- `npm run build`: Bundles the app into static files for production.
- `npm test`: Starts the test runner.
- `npm run eject`: Removes this tool and copies build dependencies into the app directory (use with caution as you can't reverse this process).

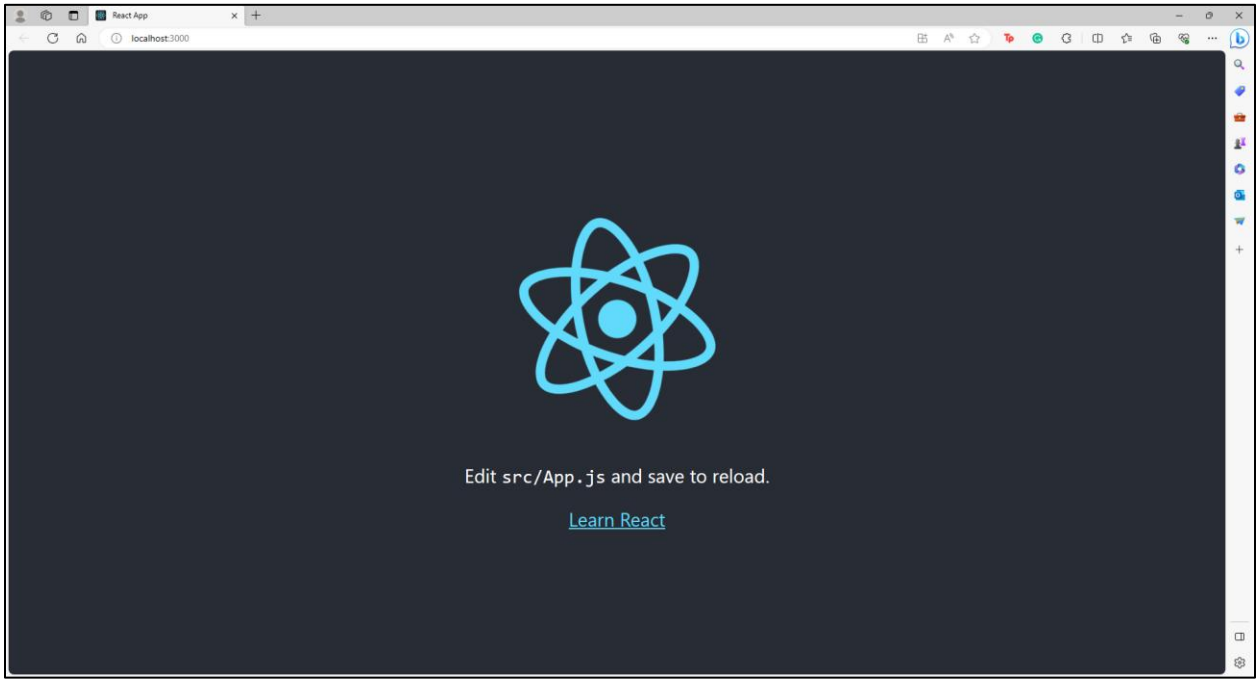
Step 4: Starting the React Application

1. **Navigate into Your Project**: Use the following command to enter your project directory:

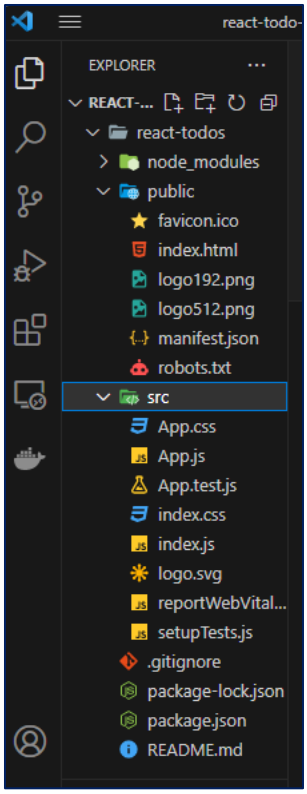
   ```
   cd react-todos
   ```

2. **Start the Application**: Type `npm start`. This will open a web browser pointing to `http://localhost:3000`, where your React application is hosted.

Note: The home page appearance may differ, as the React Team often updates the default look. If you see a successful page, congratulations! You've created your first React application.



Step 5: Exploring the Code Structure



In your project folder, you'll find:

- **Node Modules**: Contains all the libraries installed automatically when creating the React project.
- **Public Directory**: Includes favicon, logo images, the crucial `index.html` file, and other assets.
- **Source Directory**: The heart of your code, where you'll be making most of the changes.

Step 6: Making Your First Change

1. **Navigate to `app.js`**: Open this file within your source directory.
2. **Edit the Code**: Remove lines 12 to 19 (the anchor tag) and add a paragraph tag:

```
<p>We made our first React application.</p>
```

2. **Save and Observe**: Your changes will hot-reload automatically in the browser.

